- Is it possible to offload hosting and upkeep? Certainly, in your company, tools and platforms are bundled with support. But right now, you are aiming to deliver value quickly and not building infrastructure or devising backup strategies.

Naturally, you'd like to please the users first. However, remember that you are under time pressure here. Hence it's paramount to identify solutions within the technical proficiency of teams involved in your project development. For example, if you already have an operational data warehouse in your domain, there's no reason to reinvent the wheel. At this stage, the rule of the thumb is to introduce as few changes as possible.

The significant differentiation is that the data product focuses on the external users' consumption perspective, not the source system logic. This means that you are not expected to give users access to the internal storage of your source system. Instead, you need to develop a table (or a set of them) in a read-optimized form (e.g., denormalized if needed, utilizing column encoding and compression, catching aggregate tables, lowering isolation level, etc.) that is easily consumed in bulk.

TIP We encourage you not to lose time overengineering and overthinking your MVP early on. Keep things simple and grounded in the team's experience and in-house services. In the grand scheme of things, the final solution might be as basic as a series of ETL scripts in a repository being periodically executed, and dumping the results into your standard storage system. Just make sure your solution is automatic and repeatable. The MVP, at its core, most likely will not go into production. All the elements are likely to be replaced. It's also in the spirit of data mesh—think about exposing *data*, not underlying technologies.

With the first data products developed, we're ready to talk about connecting them into an actual data mesh in the next section.

3.5 Setting up the minimal platform

The self-serve infrastructure as a platform as an element of the data mesh will help your teams with various data-related tasks, including standardization and lineage, quality metrics, and monitoring logging and